

October 5, 2026

To: Michelle Curtain Stewart, EdD, Interim Vice President for Academic Affairs

From: Steven Kreutzer, Ph.D., Dean, School of Business and Computer Science

Subject: Recommendation for Advancement to Associate Professor — Vladislav D. Veksler, Ph.D.

Recommendation and basis of evaluation

I strongly recommend Vladislav D. Veksler, Ph.D., for advancement to Associate Professor. His teaching, advising, scholarship, service, and collegiality provide strong support for advancement under Sections 4.1.2.4, 4.5.1, and 4.6 of the June 2025 Faculty Handbook.

I reviewed his advancement portfolio and recommendation forms. His portfolio website is very well designed with extensive quantitative evidence of his accomplishments. In its presentation and documentation, his submission far exceeds comparable advancement applications I have reviewed. Professor Salvatore Ferraro rates him Outstanding in all five qualitative areas and strongly supports his advancement.

Quantitative criteria

Dr. Veksler holds a master's degree and a Ph.D. in Cognitive Science from Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute. He will complete five years as an Assistant Professor at Caldwell in January 2027. His earlier university teaching and professional research experience further support his qualifications.

Teaching effectiveness — Section 4.5.1.1.1

Dr. Veksler is a highly effective teacher. He reports an average Student Opinion Report rating of 4.9 out of 5.0, five consecutive Excellence in Teaching Award nominations, thirteen distinct computer science courses taught, and nine semesters of voluntary overload. Professor Ferraro's classroom observation confirms his engaging instruction and student participation. I have also observed his teaching twice at another institution and found it outstanding, particularly his energy, enthusiasm, and rapport with students.

He uses live coding, regular review of student work, and supervised programming assessments. He has also developed software to improve attendance tracking and examinations. His record shows strong subject knowledge, careful preparation, and a commitment to helping students learn.

Academic advising and mentoring — Section 4.5.1.1.2

Dr. Veksler reports forty to fifty or more advisees annually and approximately 150 to 200 recommendation letters supporting students' academic and career opportunities. He mentors five to ten undergraduate researchers during semesters, with as many as eighteen during summers.

His portfolio identifies four honors projects, fourteen student-coauthored peer-reviewed publications and presentations, and thirty-eight student posters and demonstrations at Caldwell Research and Creative Arts Day over four years. These accomplishments show the substantial time he gives students and the results of his guidance.

Scholarship — Section 4.5.1.1.3

His portfolio reports eighteen peer-reviewed publications and presentations since January 2022, ten courses developed at Caldwell, twenty-two grant proposals submitted, and five software projects released. Recent publications address programming assessment and plagiarism detection. His course development supports undergraduate programs, the STEM MBA, and the proposed MS in Computer Science.

He also reports helping secure \$25,000 in C-STEM equipment and services funding in 2025–2026, \$10,000 in 2024–2025, and \$14,000 in research-center funding in 2022–2023, along with a \$4,000 Pfizer PURE award as co-investigator. His appointment as the Alvin R. Calman Endowed Chair in May 2025 further recognizes his scholarship.

Service — Section 4.5.1.1.4

Dr. Veksler's service includes leadership of the Faculty Development Committee and Teaching and Learning Center during 2024–2026, Institutional Review Board membership, and search committee work. He founded CogAI, co-founded C-STEM, and has helped improve the School's curriculum, programs, and laboratories.

He advises three student organizations and supports intercollegiate competitions. His students have earned six first-place prizes, two second-place prizes, a Top 10 finalist placement, and an honorable mention. Campus competitions he supported included twenty-five RoboCup competitors and eighty CougarHacks participants. These activities give students opportunities and bring recognition to Caldwell.

Collegiality — Section 4.5.1.1.5

Dr. Veksler's collegiality is a clear strength. He helps colleagues with research projects, laboratory resources, websites, and teaching technology. His work with faculty in business, psychology, and biology demonstrates his willingness to share his expertise. Professor Ferraro rates his collegiality Outstanding.

Faculty in the School of Business and Computer Science were surveyed for this review. Their responses reinforce this assessment, describing Dr. Veksler as trustworthy, supportive, reliable, and approachable. The feedback recognizes his encouragement of new teaching methods, meaningful contributions to the School, and availability to answer questions. His mentoring has helped a new faculty member find the right people and resources across campus and complete the first-year review.

These examples show that Dr. Veksler takes an active interest in his colleagues' success and provides practical help with their work.

Overall evaluation

Dr. Veksler's accomplishments far exceed the criteria for advancement, and he is one of the University's top-performing faculty members. His work has strengthened the School of Business and Computer Science and created substantial opportunities for students.

His new role as Department Chair provides an important opportunity to build on these strengths. I am pleased that he has agreed to serve as Chair of the Department of Computer Science and Information Systems. The department faces serious enrollment challenges, particularly the significant decline in international students following changes in federal policy. His leadership will be important as we work to strengthen the department and attract students.

Strengthening the department also means continuing to raise expectations for student learning. He teaches students with a wide range of preparation and ability. I encourage him to raise the minimum expectations for student work while helping students with different levels of preparation meet those expectations.

The University is very fortunate to have a faculty member of Dr. Veksler's caliber. His contributions deserve recognition, and I hope we will continue to give him the support and encouragement he needs to build on his accomplishments and lead the department through its current challenges.

I strongly recommend Vladislav D. Veksler for advancement to Associate Professor.

Steven Kreutzer, Ph.D.

Dean, School of Business and Computer Science